Ruger Blackhawk & Vaquero

Ruger • New Model Single-Action Revolvers (.357 Mag, .44 Mag, .45 Colt)

Manufacturer:	Ruger	**Category:**	Revolvers
Action Type:	Single-Action Revolver with Transfer Bar Safety	**Era / Service:**	Modern Ruger Single-Action (1955–Present)
Calibers:	.357 Magnum, .44 Magnum, .45 Colt, .41 Magnum	**Covered Models:**	Blackhawk (Adjustable Sights), Super Blackhawk (.44 Mag), Vaquero (Fixed Sights), Bisley Target

KEY ARMORER TASKS & BENCH OPERATIONS

Core Procedures: Transfer Bar Clearance & Pinch Test • Loading Gate Pawl Interlock Check • Poor Boy's Trigger Job (Uncoupling Leg) • Cylinder Throat Pin Gauging (.4525") • Base Pin Latch Upgrade

CRITICAL ARMORER TOLERANCES & SPECIFICATIONS

SPECIFICATION / CLEARANCE	ARMORER TOLERANCE & BENCH SPECIFICATION
TRANSFER BAR SAFETY	Hammer cannot contact firing pin directly; hammer blow can only reach primer when trigger is held back lifting the transfer bar between them
SAFE CARRY	100% safe to carry fully loaded with all six chambers charged (unlike classic 1873 design)
LOADING GATE INTERLOCK	Opening loading gate automatically drops the cylinder bolt allowing cylinder to freewheel for loading without touching hammer

IMMEDIATE ACTION & MALFUNCTION DIAGNOSTIC MATRIX

MALFUNCTION CONDITION	PROBABLE CAUSES	ARMORER BENCH REMEDY
Stoppage 1: Cylinder Pin Jumps Forward Under Heavy Recoil **Firing heavy magnum loads causes cylinder pin to slide forward, binding cylinder rotation**	• Factory spring-loaded base pin latch nut has shallow detent angle. • High recoil inertia of .44 Mag / heavy .45 Colt loads compressing latch spring.	**Gunsmith Action: Install Belt Mountain heavy-duty locking base pin with set screw. Set screw locks pin securely into barrel underlug recess.**

CURATED BENCH VIDEO REFERENCES

PROCEDURE TITLE	INSTRUCTOR / CREATOR	TECHNICAL PROCEDURE SUMMARY
Ruger Blackhawk Complete Disassembly & Transfer Bar Inspection	MidwayUSA / Larry Potterfield	Full teardown of the Ruger New Model single-action frame, transfer bar linkage, coil mainspring strut, and cylinder base pin assembly.